

12. Strengths & Positive Descriptors

Use these words and phrases to lead with what the child does well.

Every observation and every family conversation should begin with the child's strengths. These terms describe genuine, observable capacities — not hollow praise.

Character & Approach to Learning

curious	persistent	creative
imaginative	detail-oriented	methodical
inventive	enthusiastic about learning	loves to explore
asks thoughtful questions	observant	remembers details others miss
approaches new materials with openness	tries new things when supported	keeps trying after mistakes

Social Strengths

warm and affectionate with familiar adults	shows genuine care for peers	notices when others are sad
shares materials when prompted	shares materials spontaneously	includes peers in play
greet others warmly	is sought out by peers as a play partner	makes peers laugh
advocates for themselves verbally	expresses preferences clearly	

Communication Strengths

communicates needs clearly	rich vocabulary for age	tells detailed stories
asks relevant questions	listens attentively during read-aloud	remembers and retells story details
uses humor and playfulness in language	explains their thinking step by step	communicates through multiple modes
makes their needs known clearly		

Physical & Creative Strengths

strong gross motor skills	excellent balance and coordination	precise fine motor control
talented builder and engineer	expressive and creative in art	musical — responds to rhythm and beat
physically energetic and healthy	strong spatial awareness	excellent at puzzles and patterns
uses body to express ideas expressively		

Self-Awareness & Regulation Strengths		
knows own feelings and names them	asks for what they need	takes breaks independently
uses the calm-down corner effectively	accepts redirection gracefully	bounces back quickly from disappointment
comfortable asking for help	reads the room and adjusts	responds well to routine and predictability
flexible when supports are in place		